



Artist's impression of wave power machines used in the Aguçadoura wave farm

2008

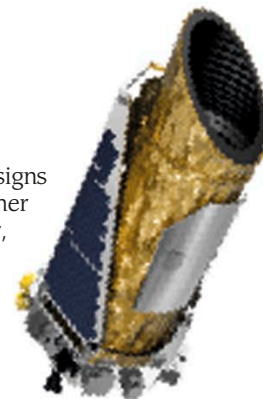
First commercial wave farm

The Aguçadoura Wave Farm opened 3 miles (5 km) off the coast of Portugal. It features three wave-power machines—394-ft- (120-m-) long, hinged cylinders with joints between sections. The up and down movement of the sections caused by waves was harnessed to drive generators, which produce electricity.

2009

Kepler space observatory is launched

The Kepler space observatory monitors thousands of stars in the Milky Way for signs of exoplanets (planets that orbit stars other than the Sun). Kepler uses a photometer, a device that measures the intensity of light, to detect variations in a star's brightness caused by an exoplanet passing in front of it while orbiting the star. Within its first seven years, more than 1,280 exoplanets were detected.

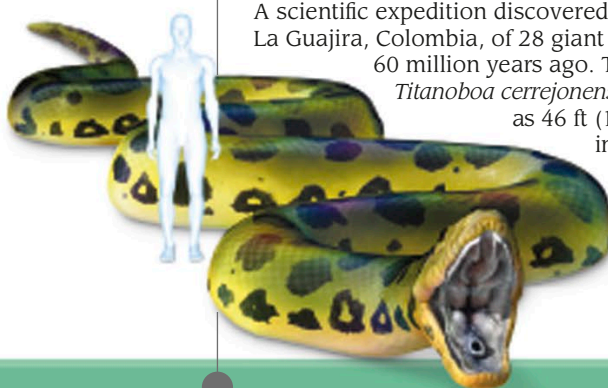


2009

Titanoboa fossils discovered

A scientific expedition discovered fossilized remains in La Guajira, Colombia, of 28 giant snakes that lived about 60 million years ago. The species, named

Titanoboa cerrejonensis, measured as long as 46 ft (14 m), with the biggest individuals estimated to have weighed more than 2,425 lb (1,100 kg). *Titanoboa* had jaws large enough to swallow a whole adult crocodile.



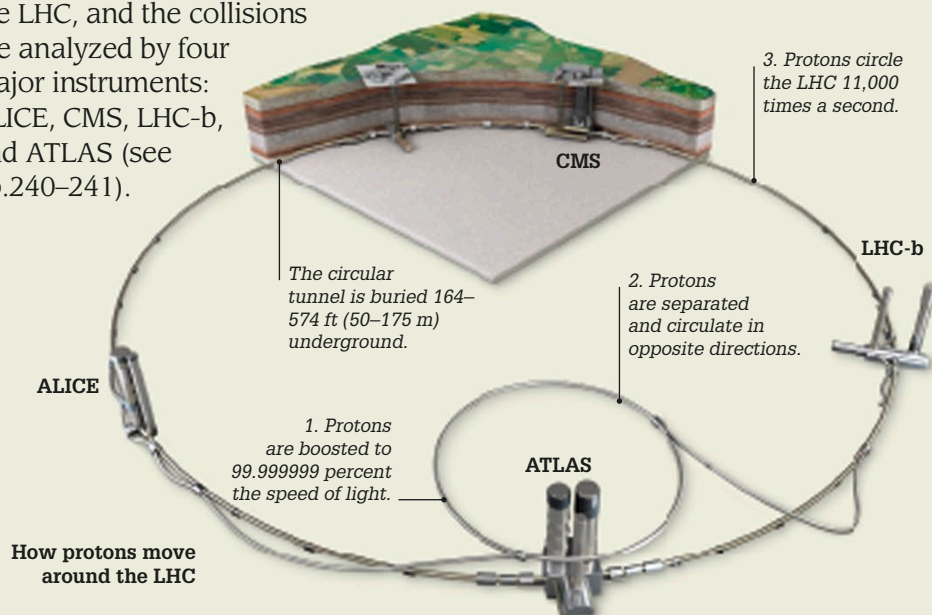
2010



Taking to the skies
See pages 162–163

2008 LARGE HADRON COLLIDER

The Large Hadron Collider (LHC) is a 17-mile- (27-km-) long, artificial underground tunnel on the French-Swiss border. It was completed in 2008. More than 6,000 electromagnets accelerate protons around the LHC at close to the speed of light. These protons collide at four locations within the LHC, and the collisions are analyzed by four major instruments: ALICE, CMS, LHC-b, and ATLAS (see pp.240–241).



The first Apple iPhone was launched in 2007 complete with a multi-touch touchscreen.